



POLESTAR MIDDLE EAST WEEKLY

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 16 SEPTEMBER 2026 - 22 SEPTEMBER 2026

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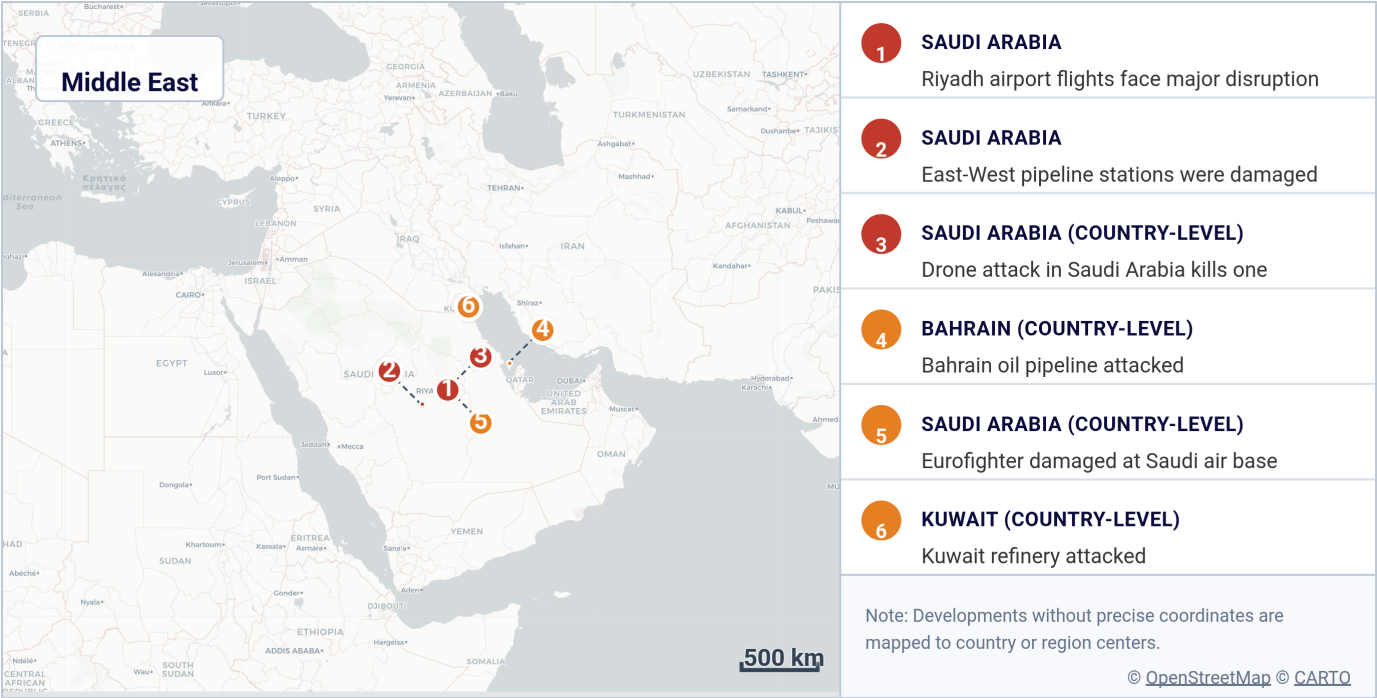
REGIONAL OUTLOOK

The week's most consequential exposure was the direct interruption at Riyadh airport, where delays and cancellations were recorded before operations returned to normal. That stands out because it immediately affected staff movement and time-sensitive journeys through a major regional hub, even though the disruption was not sustained.

A separate operating issue is the concentration of attacks touching Gulf energy infrastructure. Confirmed damage to Saudi East-West pipeline stations is the strongest signal because physical harm to a strategic asset is established, while the Bahrain pipeline attack and Kuwait refinery attack extend the regional watchlist without yet confirming service loss. Together, these incidents keep continuity and asset-protection planning elevated beyond a single transport disruption.

WEEK AT A GLANCE

MATERIAL DEVELOPMENTS	MARKETS REQUIRING WATCH	HIGH OR EXTREME DEVELOPMENTS	7-DAY WATCH ITEMS
6	3	3	3



REGIONAL RISK PICTURE

The clearest transmission into business activity came from Riyadh airport. Recorded delays and cancellations affected flight availability and could complicate staff travel or time-sensitive shipments if disruption recurs. With normal operations reported, a continuing outage or residual backlog should not be assumed.

The Saudi pipeline-station attack presents a different risk path. Physical damage to energy infrastructure is confirmed, but the facts do not establish service interruption. Even so, the combination of that damage with attacks involving a Bahrain pipeline and a Kuwait refinery raises contingent exposure for operators, contractors and industrial users if further incidents begin to affect facility availability.

Additional Saudi security incidents sharpen the operating backdrop, but the reported facts do not by themselves show wider commercial disruption at those locations.

KEY DEVELOPMENTS

SAUDI ARABIA | RIYADH AIRPORT RIYADH AIRPORT FLIGHTS FACE MAJOR DISRUPTION

Operational Disruption · High · 19 Sep 2026

ASSESSMENT: Riyadh airport faced major flight disruption after flames and smoke were seen nearby. Delays and cancellations were recorded at Riyadh airport. Airport operations later recovered to normal.

POLESTAR VIEW: This was the clearest immediate business disruption, followed by reported recovery. A fresh interruption would matter more than assuming the airport remains affected.

7-DAY INDICATOR: Watch for renewed cancellations, airport advisories, or another disruption near Riyadh airport.

SAUDI ARABIA EAST-WEST PIPELINE STATIONS WERE DAMAGED

Security · High · 16 Sep 2026

ASSESSMENT: A drone attack damaged Saudi East-West pipeline stations.

POLESTAR VIEW: Damage is confirmed, but service disruption is not. Risk rises mainly if outages or further strikes on linked assets are verified.

7-DAY INDICATOR: Look for confirmation of station status, repair activity, or any interruption to pipeline operations.

SAUDI ARABIA DRONE ATTACK IN SAUDI ARABIA KILLS ONE

Security · High · 17 Sep 2026

ASSESSMENT: A Houthi drone attack in Saudi Arabia killed one person.

POLESTAR VIEW: The incident raises duty-of-care concern, but broader commercial impact depends on location details or further attacks.

7-DAY INDICATOR: Watch for official clarification of the attack location and any link to civilian or commercial facilities.

**BAHRAIN | BAHRAIN OIL PIPELINE
BAHRAIN OIL PIPELINE ATTACKED****Energy · Moderate · 19 Sep 2026**

ASSESSMENT: A hostile attack targeted a Bahrain oil pipeline.

POLESTAR VIEW: This is a warning signal for asset security, but operational consequences cannot be assumed without confirmation of damage or outage.

7-DAY INDICATOR: Look for confirmation on pipeline damage, containment measures, or any reported operational effect.

**SAUDI ARABIA | SAUDI AIR BASE
EUROFIGHTER DAMAGED AT SAUDI AIR BASE****Armed Conflict · Moderate · 19 Sep 2026**

ASSESSMENT: A missile attack damaged a Eurofighter at a Saudi air base.

POLESTAR VIEW: The damage matters for the security climate, but no broader commercial disruption is established at civilian operating sites.

7-DAY INDICATOR: Watch for any official detail on location or whether nearby civilian operations were affected.

**KUWAIT | KUWAIT REFINERY
KUWAIT REFINERY ATTACKED****Operational Disruption · Moderate · 18 Sep 2026**

ASSESSMENT: A refinery in Kuwait was attacked.

POLESTAR VIEW: The attack is confirmed, yet operating impact is unverified. Risk intensifies only if damage or output effects are later confirmed.

7-DAY INDICATOR: Look for identification of the refinery and any statement on damage, safety measures, or operating status.

BUSINESS IMPLICATIONS

Travel teams can retain alternative routings for staff using Riyadh, but normal airport operations were subsequently reported. Renewed cancellations or official restriction notices, rather than an assumed continuing outage, should trigger changes to journeys and staff rotations through the airport.

Asset and site-security teams should review protection measures and maintenance access assumptions around strategic facilities, triggered by confirmed damage to Saudi pipeline stations and attacks on a Bahrain pipeline and a Kuwait refinery. Since wider outages are not confirmed, resilience checks are better grounded than output-adjustment decisions.

Regional continuity leads should tighten thresholds for escalating incident response, triggered by multiple Saudi security incidents alongside infrastructure attacks in neighbouring markets. The key decision is when to shift from monitoring to cross-functional coordination if further verified attacks begin affecting commercial transport or operating assets directly.

7 DAY WATCH

23 Sep 2026 | SAUDI ARABIA — National Day closures and celebrations

Why it matters: School, bank, and government office closures could disrupt routine services and increase local traffic around celebrations if plans proceed as described.

Watch: Closure confirmations and schedules for concerts, fireworks, and cultural events.

26 Sep 2026 | YEMEN — September Revolution Day observed

Why it matters: A national holiday could reduce government operating hours and affect routine services if broadly observed.

Watch: Official holiday notices and any changes to public service operating hours.

26 Sep 2026 | ISRAEL — Sukkot public holiday begins

Why it matters: Public holiday observance could reduce office hours, alter transport schedules, and slow some routine administrative activity if widely observed.

Watch: Holiday service notices from government offices, transit operators, and major businesses.

POLESTAR OUTLOOK

The priority for the coming week is whether attacks begin to produce sustained service losses, rather than remaining a series of localised security shocks. Riyadh airport's recovery is a stabilising signal; confirmed damage to Saudi pipeline stations leaves a different test, centred on repairs and continuity. Attacks involving energy assets in Bahrain and Kuwait could widen supply exposure if damage, lower throughput or extended shutdowns are verified.

Aviation and energy should therefore be judged by separate operating indicators: repeated cancellations would worsen mobility risk, while confirmed processing or pipeline interruptions would matter more for industrial continuity. The fatal drone attack and damaged military aircraft warrant follow-on monitoring, not assumed commercial interruption. Shipping restrictions or regulatory decisions affecting flows also require separate confirmation. Clear restoration notices, normal transport schedules and evidence that damaged assets remain serviceable would ease the assessment. Further attacks accompanied by sustained closures or verified output losses would materially worsen it.

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